



2ND WEEK: **DAY 14**

New beginnings

YOUR BABY TODAY

Now that you are getting the hang of being a new mom, seek out other new parents for some exercise or socializing. There should be many options available to you in your local area.

“ Life will never be the same again, and by now you will understand the unconditional love of parents for their child. ”

Babies like to suck, even when they're not hungry anymore. Some suck their fingers or thumbs, but others do nicely with pacifiers. Some parents have strong feelings about whether or not to give a baby a pacifier, but they won't hurt your baby at all and have been linked to a reduction in Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS) when used during sleep. If you decide to use pacifiers, look for models with soft nipples and a one-piece design that are dishwasher-safe. Have several on hand, since pacifiers tend to fall on the floor. Keep in mind that if a baby depends on a pacifier to sleep, they may wake up and cry if it falls out of. If you are breastfeeding, many experts recommend waiting one month before introducing a pacifier, to avoid nipple confusion.

You may now be getting out more by yourself since your partner may be back at work. Ask your pediatrician about times and venues for support groups in your local area and any stroller-walking groups or baby massage classes since these are excellent ways to meet other moms.

Although you are probably now getting the hang of being parents, it is normal at times to feel completely exhausted. This is a major life change, particularly if this is your first baby, and it can be hard to anticipate all of the changes that are needed to look after a newborn. Take a breath and be reassured that it will get easier. This newborn stage can sometimes feel endless, but cherish the time as soon your baby will no longer be that precious newborn bundle.

PHOTOS AND VIDEOS

It's tempting to take photos and videos almost constantly when your first baby is born. Digital photography means that you can email family and friends immediately with new baby images. Subsequent children often remark on how relatively few photos there are of them! However, be aware of how keeping this photographic record, and always having your phone on hand for photos and videos, may sometimes get in the way of just being present with your baby.

ASK A DOCTOR
